

ECHO — Every Choice Leaves a Future

Hackathon Concept:

We are going to create a **browser-based narrative strategy game** where the player's decisions about sustainability directly shape the future of their city.

Core Idea

The player starts in **2026** and makes decisions about things like:

- Energy
- Transport
- Waste
- Urban development
- Industry
- Water
- Food
- Biodiversity
- Economy

Every decision has **short-term benefits and long-term consequences**.

The game progresses through:

2026 → 2030 → 2040 → 2050

The important mechanic is that **past decisions affect future situations and even change the choices available later**.

Example

The player chooses to build a highway in 2026.

Initially:

- Economy ↑
- Jobs ↑
- Transport ↑

But later:

- Traffic ↑
- Pollution ↑
- Green spaces ↓

By 2040, the player may face a completely different situation because of that original decision.

Gameplay System

The game will track several variables:

- 🌱 Environmental Health
- 💰 Economy
- 😊 Quality of Life
- ⚡ Energy Sustainability
- 🏙️ Infrastructure
- 🌍 Climate Impact

The player has to **balance these instead of simply maximizing one score.**

Final 2050 Outcome

At the end, the game generates the future created by the player:

“This is the future your choices created.”

It will show things like:

- Air quality
- CO₂ emissions
- Renewable energy percentage
- Biodiversity
- Quality of life
- Economic stability

The city/world will also visually change based on the player's decisions.

Gamification

We'll include:

- Achievements/badges
- Progression
- Multiple possible futures/endings
- Branching decisions
- A timeline showing major choices
- A final **Future Report**
- Potential replayability: *“What happens if I make different choices?”*

SDGs

The main focus will be:

SDG 11 — Sustainable Cities & Communities

SDG 12 — Responsible Consumption & Production

SDG 13 — Climate Action

Potentially also **SDG 7 & SDG 15**.

Tech

A **browser game** using **HTML, CSS and JavaScript**, designed with a polished, modern game UI.

The main message of ECHO:

“You don't choose the future. You create it.”